

COMPARATIVE RELIGIONS

SEGMENT 6

INDIAN RELIGIONS



HINDUISM



CHRISTIANITY



ISLAM



JAINISM



BUDDHISM



SIKHS-SIKHISM



ZOROASRIANISM

HINDUISM



CONCEPT OF GOD

- **CASTE SYSTEM**

- Brahman
- Kashtri
- Vaish
- Shooder



What is Hinduism?

- ≡ One of the oldest religions of humanity
- ≡ The religion of the Indian people
- ≡ Gave birth to Buddhism, Jainism, Sikhism
- ≡ Tolerance and diversity: "Truth is one, paths are many"
- ≡ Many deities but a single, impersonal Ultimate Reality
- ≡ A philosophy and a way of life – focused both on this world and beyond

How does Hinduism direct life in this world?



- ≡ Respect for all life – vegetarian
- ≡ Human life as supreme:
 - ◆ Four “stations” of life (Caste) - priests & teachers, nobles & warriors, merchant class, servant class
 - ◆ Four stages of life – student, householder, retired, renunciant
 - ◆ Four duties of life – pleasure, success, social responsibilities, religious responsibilities (moksha)

What are the Sacred Texts?



- **Shruti** ("heard") – oldest, most authoritative:
 - Four **Vedas** ("truth") – myths, rituals, chants
 - **Upanishads** - metaphysical speculation
 - Plus other texts
- **Smriti** ("remembered") – the Great Indian Epics:
 - **Ramayana**
 - **Mahabharata** (includes **Bhagavad-Gita**)
 - Plus others

CHRISTIANITY



JESUS CHRIST THEME



Anonymous uploader

OPENWALL



Trinity



Just like the
3 colors in
the candy corn I see.

There are 3
persons in the
Holy Trinity:
GOD the FATHER
GOD the SON, JESUS
GOD the HOLY SPIRIT

All 3 are GOD,
yet together
they are One.

What Quran Says about **TRINITY ?**

فَتَأْمِنُوا بِاللَّهِ وَرُسُلِهِ وَلَا تَقُولُوا ثَلَاثَةً

So believe in Allah and His messengers. And do not say, "Three"

إِنَّمَا إِلَهُ الْوَاحِدُ شَهِدَهُ أَنْ يَكُونَ لَهُ وَلَدٌ

Indeed, Allah is but one God. Exalted is He above having a son

OLD TESTAMENT

Genesis	Daniel
Exodus	Hosea
Leviticus	Joel
Numbers	Amos
Deuteronomy	Obadiah
Joshua	Jonah
Judges	Micah
Ruth	
1 & 2 Samuel	
1 & 2 Kings	
1 & 2 Chronicles	
Ezra	
Nehemiah	
Esther	
Job	
Psalms	
Proverbs	
Ecclesiastes	
Song of Solomon	
Isaiah	
Jeremiah	
Lamentations	
Ezekiel	



Nahum
Habakkuk
Zephaniah
Haggai
Zechariah
Malachi

NEW TESTAMENT

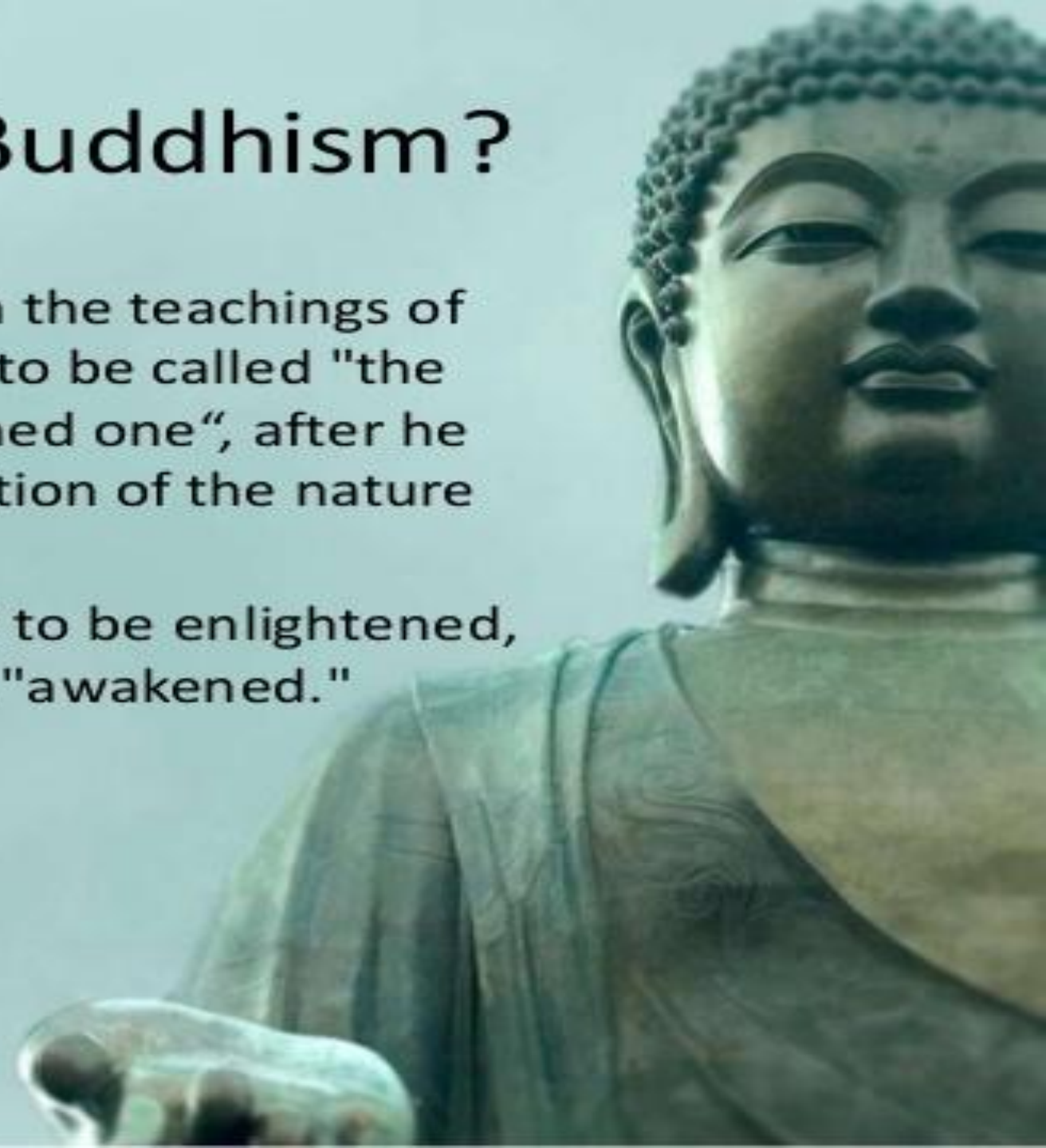
	Matthew
	Mark
	Luke
	John
	Acts
	Romans
	1 & 2 Corinthians
	Galatians
	Ephesians
	Philippians
	Colossians
	1 & 2 Thessalonians
	1 & 2 Timothy
	Titus
	Philemon
	Hebrews
	James
	1 & 2 Peter
	1, 2 & 3 John
	Jude
	Revelation

BUDHAISM



What is Buddhism?

- Buddhism is a religion based on the teachings of Siddhartha Gautama. He came to be called "the Buddha" which means "awakened one", after he experienced a profound realization of the nature of life, death and existence.
- In English, the Buddha was said to be enlightened, although in Sanskrit it is bodhi, "awakened."



Buddhism —

Background Information

- Buddhism started in India by the “Buddha,” or Siddhartha Gautama
- Founder: Siddhartha Gautama = an Indian prince who sought to eliminate suffering and devoted his life to achieving nirvana;



Buddhism as a Philosophical Foundation of Education I

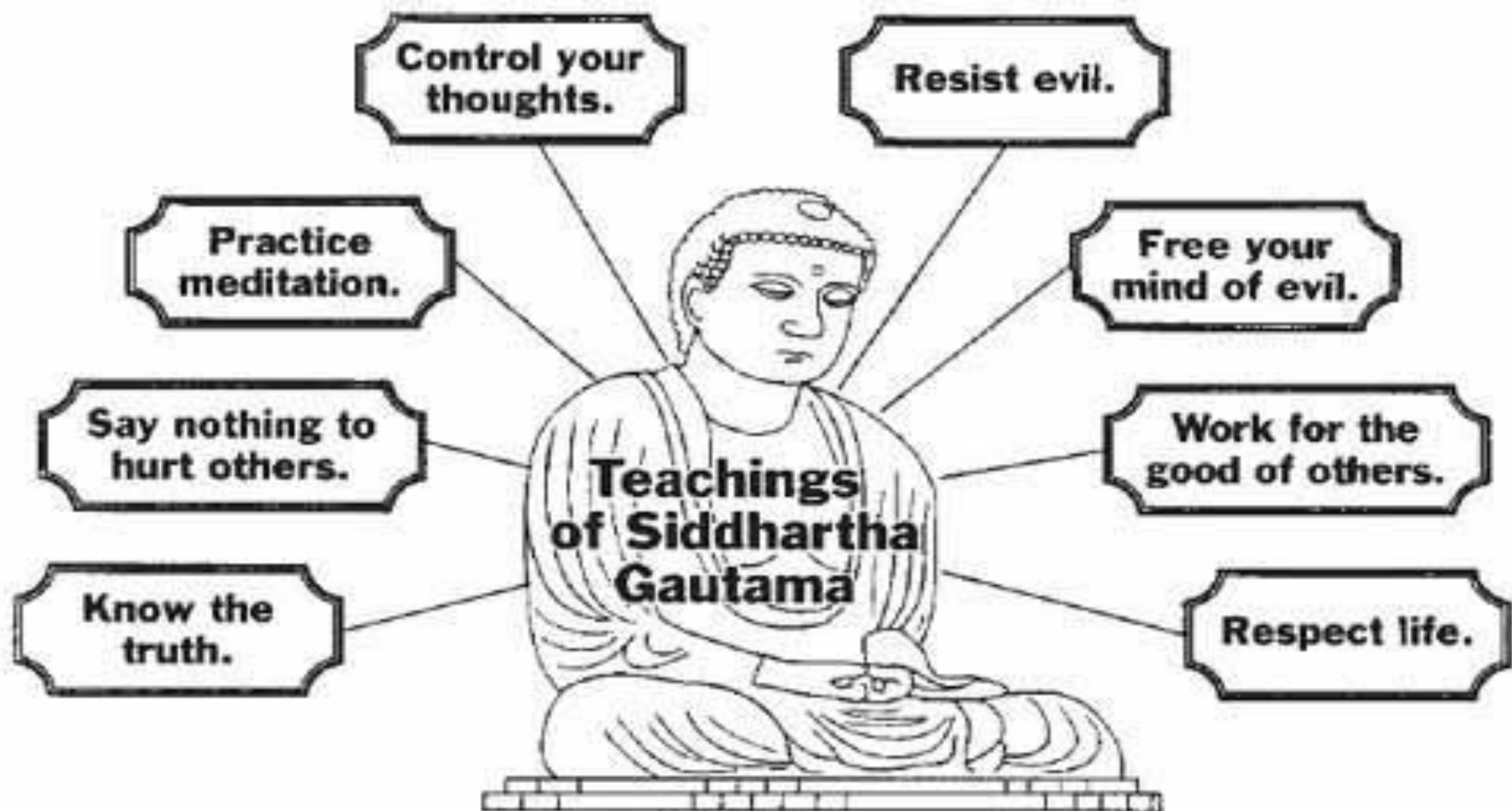
The 4 Noble Truths

1. Life is full of suffering.
2. Suffering is caused by our worldly desires.
3. Our suffering can be brought to an end.
4. Our suffering can be ended by following the Eightfold Path (Dharma).



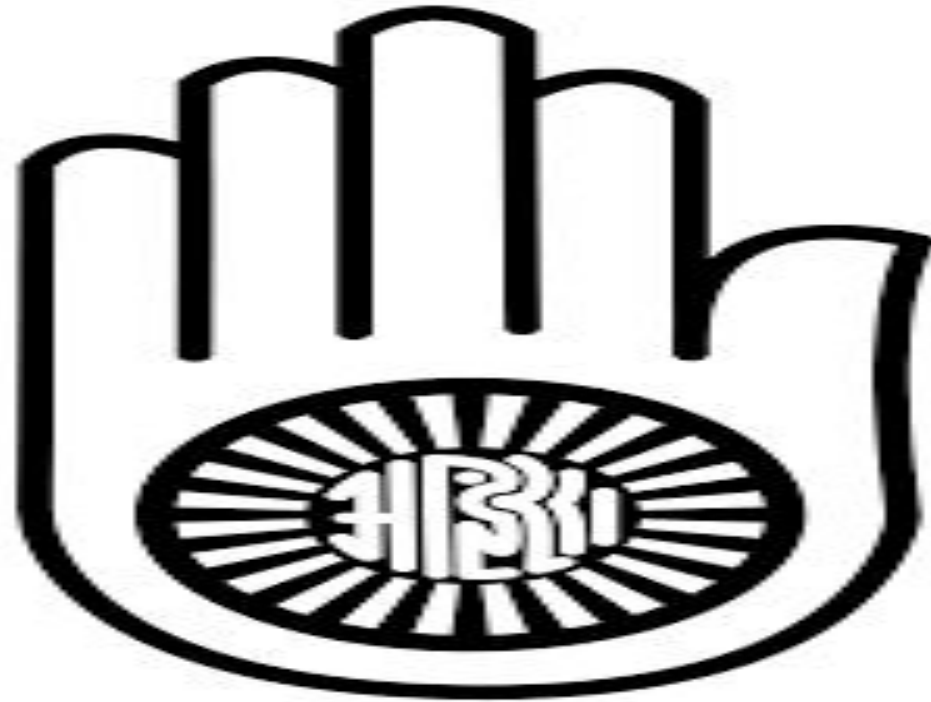
Noble 8-Fold Path





The Eightfold Path

JAINISM



Mahavira

- 599 B.C. – 527 B.C.
- Prince in Bihar, India
- Raised a Hindu
- Believed Hinduism put too much emphasis on rituals
- 30 years old – left home became a monk
- 12 years – meditation and fasting
- Finally believed he achieved perfect perception, knowledge, power, and bliss (keval-jnana)

Ahimsa

• **Non-Violence**

Satya

• **Truth**

Asteya

• **Non stealing and not to receive anything which was not voluntarily given**

Aparigraha

• **Non possession**

Brahmacharya

• **Celibacy**



ZOROASTRIANISM



The Basics

- Founder: Zoroaster or Zarathustra
- Founded circa 600 BCE possibly earlier
- Belief in one supreme god Ahura Mazda “Wise Lord”
- “Ethics based” faith
- Duality between good and evil

Faravahar – Zoroastrian Symbol

- Ahura Mazda?
- God is supposed to not have form; transcendent
- Fravashi – The good part of the human soul given by Ahura Mazda at birth.



PERSIAN RELIGION

■ Zarathustra and his faith

- Earliest Persian religion resembled that of the Aryans
- Zoroastrianism, emerged from teachings of Zarathustra

■ The *Gathas*

- Zoroastrian teachings, transmitted orally, many perished
- Preserved later in writing, by *magi*
- Compilation of the holy scriptures, *Zend Avesta*, under Sasanid dynasty
- Zarathustra's own writing survived, known as *Gathas*

■ Zoroastrian teachings

- Ahura Mazda as a supreme deity, with six lesser deities
- Cosmic conflict between Ahura Mazda and Angra Mainyu (Ahriman, Shaitan)
- Heavenly paradise and hellish realm as reward and punishment
- The material world as a blessing
- Moral formula: good words, good thoughts, good deeds

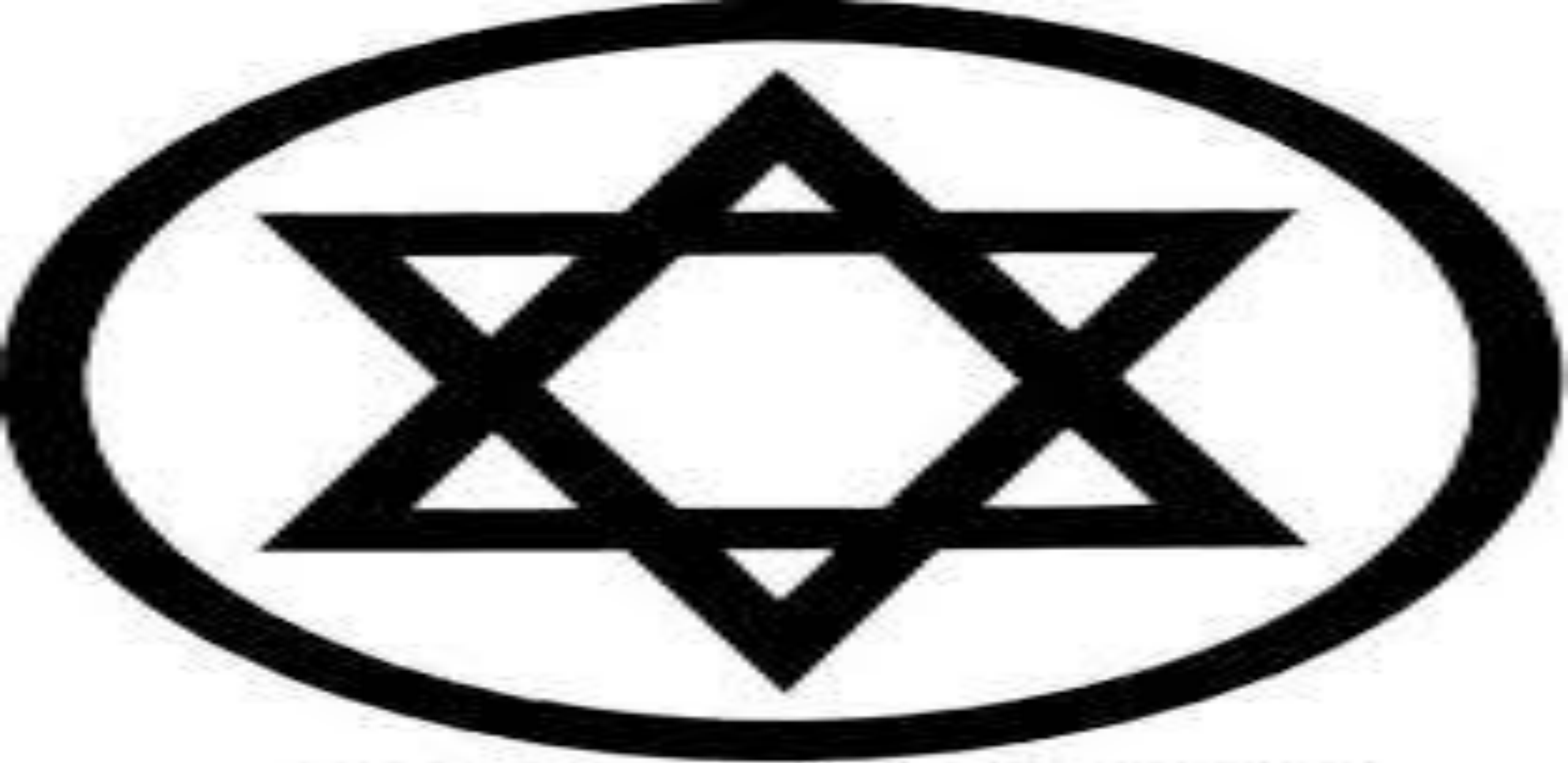
■ Popularity of Zoroastrianism

- Attracted Persian aristocrats and ruling elites
- Darius regarded Ahura Mazda as supreme God
- The faith was most popular in Iran
- Sizable followings in Mesopotamia, Anatolia, Egypt, and other regions



AHURA MAZDA
"HOLY SPIRIT"





JUDAISM

Judaism

- Monotheistic= believe in one god
- Follow prophets: Moses & Abraham
- Sacred texts: Torah (first 5 books of Bible, Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers, Deuteronomy)
- 10 Commandments= foundation for Jewish law → God' Law & basic moral code for Jews, Christians, & Muslims



Sikhism



Introduction



Sikhism

A Sikh is any person whose faith consists of belief in One God, the ten Sikh Gurus and the Guru Granth Sahib.

Origins of Sikhism

- Born in the **Punjab** which now falls into the present day states of **India** and **Pakistan**.
- The main religions of the area at the time were **Hinduism** and **Islam**.
- The Sikh faith began around **1500** CE, when Guru Nanak began teaching a faith that was quite distinct from Hinduism and Islam.
- **Nine** Gurus followed Nanak and developed the Sikh faith and community over the next centuries.



Holy Book



The Holy Book Of Sikhism is **Guru Granth Sahib**. Guru Gobind Singh declared before his departure to the heavenly abode that this Holy Granth would be the spiritual guide for Sikhs.



THE FIVE K'S

All Sikh men wear five signs of their faith. Each begins with the letter K in Punjabi. They are known as the Five K's.

KESH

Sikhs do not cut their hair or beard.



KANGA

A comb to keep the hair in place.



KIRPAN

A sword to defend the faith, the poor and helpless.



KARA

A steel wristband reminds Sikhs of one God without beginning or end.



KACHERA

Baggy shorts that Sikhs used to wear into battle.



Most Sikhs also wear a turban to keep the hair neat and tidy, and to resemble Guru Gobind Singh.







يَا أَيَّتُهَا النَّفْسُ الْمُطْمَئِنَّةُ ارْجِعِي إِلَىٰ رَبِّكِ رَاضِيَةً مَّرْضِيَّةً فَادْخُلِي

فِي عِبَادِي وَأَدْخُلِي جَنَّتِي ۖ

النَّفْسُ الْمُطْمَئِنَّةُ

